2. Setting up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

Aim:

To set up access to Zoho Creator and explore its interface, application creation options and the roles of forms, reports, pages, workflows and administration tools.

Definition:

Zoho Creator is a low-code application development platform that combines visual development tools with scripting. It supports the creation of data-entry forms, reports, custom pages and business workflows, while Deluge enables additional application logic.

Platform Architecture:

At a conceptual level, an application combines a user interface, structured data, business logic and access controls. Forms collect information; stored records are presented through reports; pages bring components together; workflows respond to events or schedules.

Component	Purpose
Forms and fields	Define the information collected and the data types used. Regular forms store submitted records.
Reports	Display records through views, filters, sorting and grouping.
Pages	Combine forms, reports and other interface elements into custom screens or dashboards.
Workflows and Deluge	Validate input and execute business rules or automated actions.
Connections and integrations	Enable authorized communication with external services and APIs.
Administration	Manage users, access, deployment environments and operational settings.

Requirements:

A web browser, an internet connection and access to a Zoho account. Available features depend on the account permissions and subscription.

Procedure:

1. Open the Zoho Creator website in a web browser.

2. Choose the sign-up option if a new account is needed. Enter the requested details and complete verification when prompted. For an existing account, sign in directly.

3. Access Zoho Creator and locate the Applications area in the administration console.

4. Choose Create Application and examine the available options: Create using Zia, Create from scratch, Create from gallery and Import from file.

5. For a basic practice application, choose Create from scratch and provide an appropriate application name.

6. In the application editor, locate Forms, Reports, Pages and Workflows. Identify the purpose of each component.

7. Examine field types in the form builder, record views in Reports, interface components in Pages and event/action settings in Workflows.

8. Locate user management and application settings. Review how access and configuration are administered.

9. When a practice form is available, submit sample data and inspect its report to understand the relationship between form inputs and stored records.

Output - Platform Website:

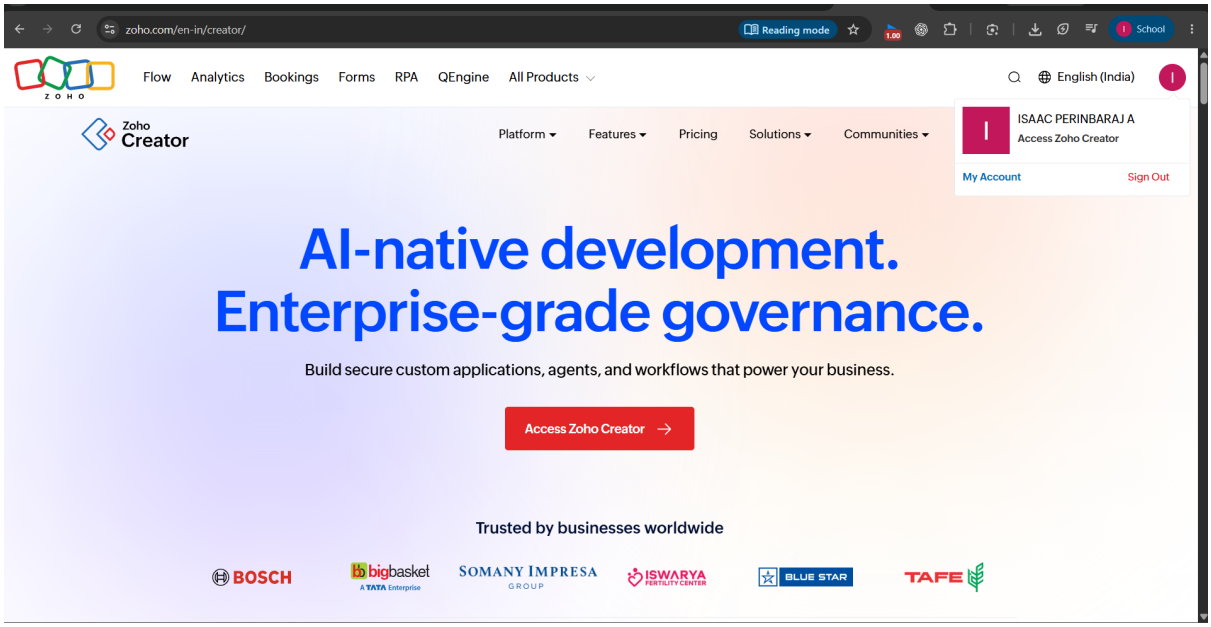


Figure 1. Zoho Creator website and platform access option.

Output - Account Access and Application Creation:

The sign-in interface provides account access. The application creation screen offers visual, template-based, import-based and AI-assisted starting points.

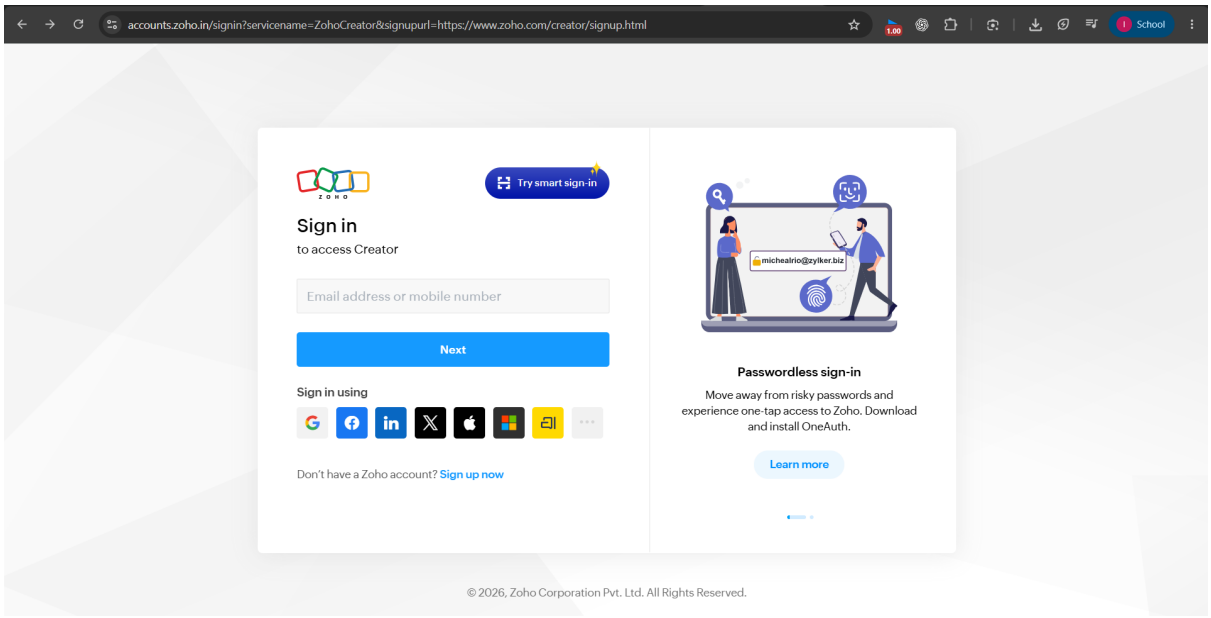


Figure 2. Zoho Creator sign-in interface.

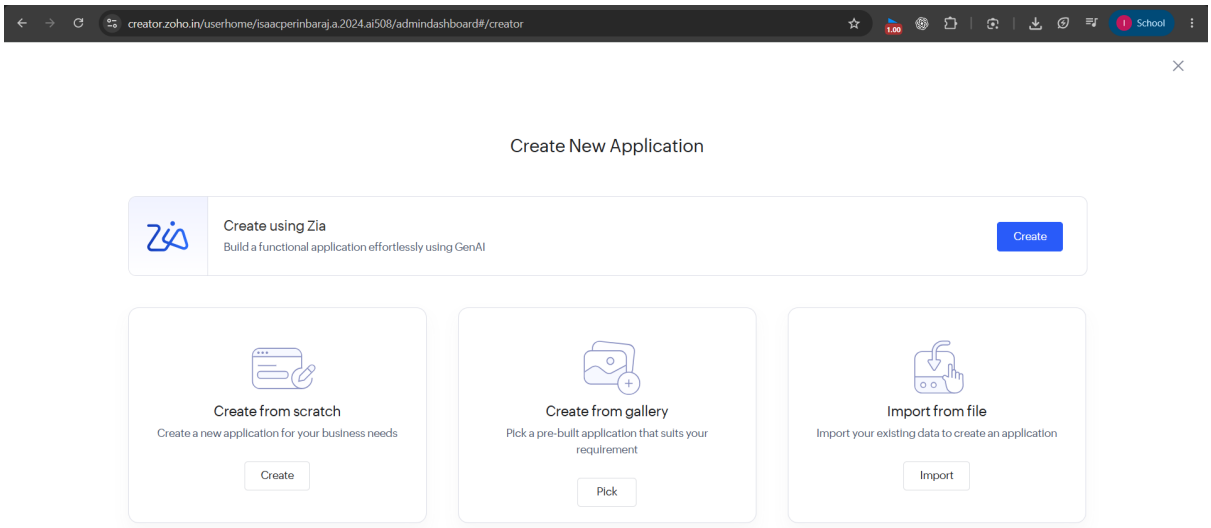


Figure 3. Create New Application options.

Output - Administration Interface:

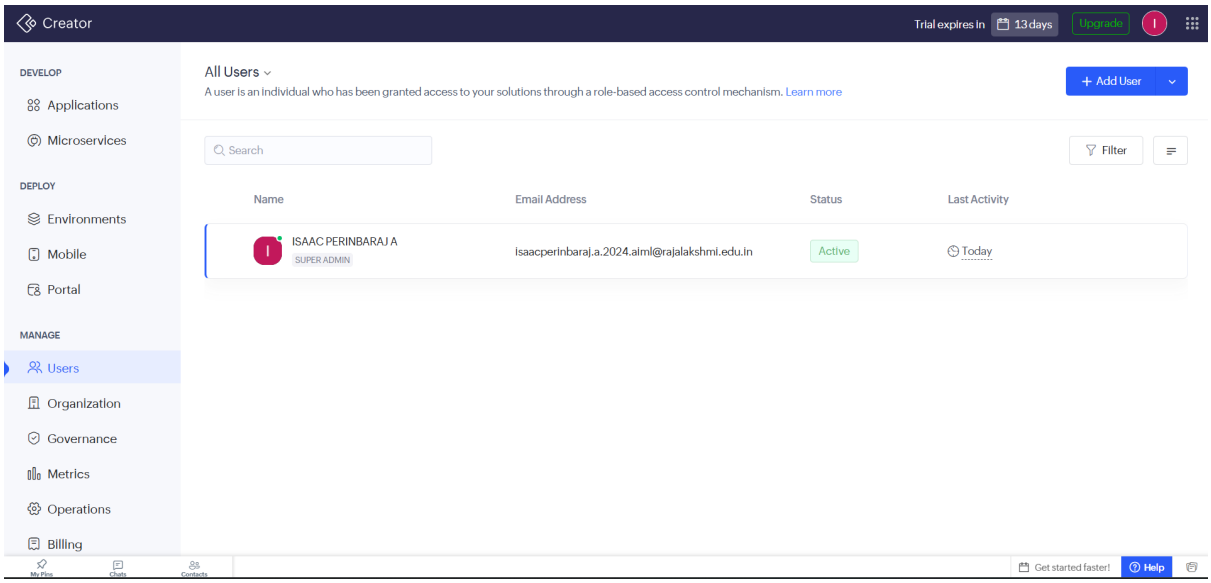


Figure 4. User management controls, including Add User, search and filtering.

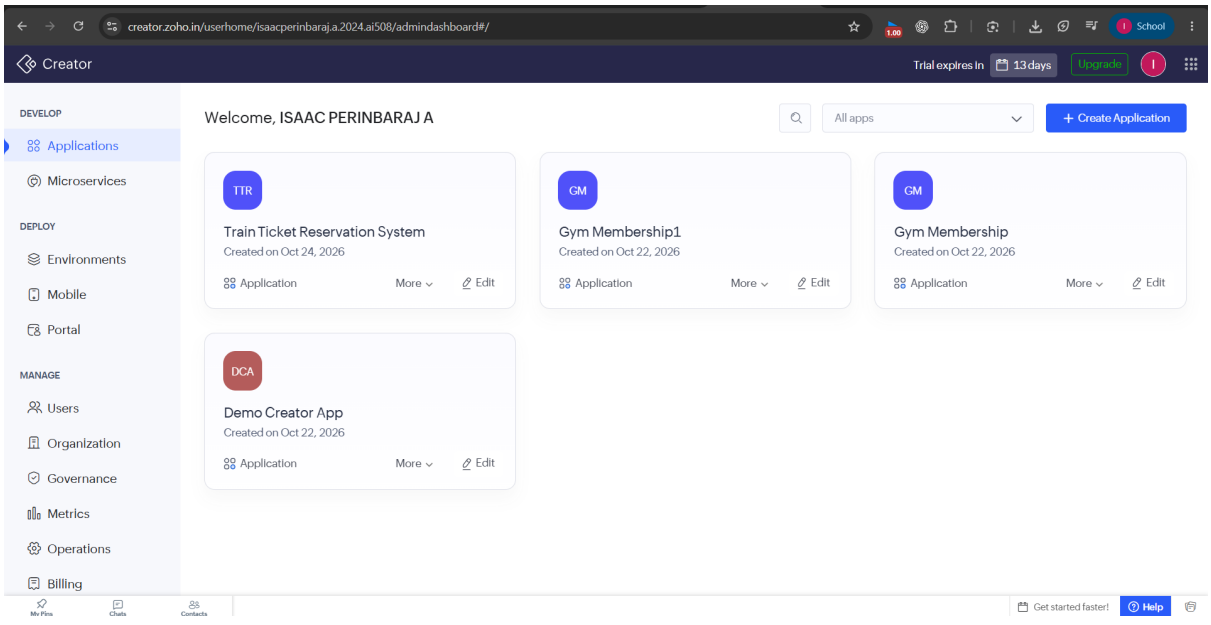


Figure 5. Applications screen and Develop, Deploy and Manage navigation.

Result:

Access to Zoho Creator and its application creation and administration interfaces was documented. The roles of Forms, Reports, Pages, Workflows, Deluge and integrations were studied, providing an understanding of how the major components fit together in a low-code application.